ARCHDIOCESE OF MOBILE

Office of the Permanent Diaconate

Ministerial Agreement

Name of Deacon: _____

Name of Parish: _____

Term of Agreement (three years): _____ TO _____
NB: Renewed every three years or upon assignment of new pastor.

Deacons are ordained to be of Service as Ministers of the Liturgy, Word, and Charity. The above-named deacon will serve his parish in these fields as outlined in this agreement.

Each week, the above-named deacon will render at least _____ hours of service to his parish. These hours of service will be in areas of need as seen by the pastor. The time mentioned here does NOT include time spent in the ministry of Liturgy. It will be up to the pastor and the deacon to see that the deacon has quality time to spend with his family, also. This important need must be safeguarded. For this reason, this agreement must bear the approval of the deacon's wife.

Ministry of Liturgy

_____
_____
_____
_____
_____

Ministry of Word

_____
_____
_____
_____

Ministry of Charity

_____
_____
_____
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_____

MINIMUM EXPECTATIONS FOR DIACONAL MINISTRY:

A. Each Deacon ordained less than five years must have an approved Ministry Agreement with a parish or with the archdiocese directly. This Ministry Agreement must be approved by the Pastor; the Deacon; if married, by the Deacon's spouse; and then reviewed by the Director of the Permanent Diaconate at the annual meeting.
B. Each deacon must fulfill the liturgical and other outlined functions defined in his agreement with his parish.
C. Each deacon must fulfill his obligations for continuing education, quarterly meetings, and the annual retreat as specified in the Continuing Education Guidelines.
D. The annual cost of the annual retreat for both the deacon and his wife is to be paid by the parish with whom he has this agreement.
E. Deacons receiving a voluntary offering for the administration of sacraments follow the same regulations as those set down for priests. A personal gift given to a deacon (or priest) at the time of the administration of a sacrament would belong properly to him. C.I.C. #531
F. The pastor/administrator and deacon should meet regularly at a time that is mutually agreeable. The pastor is to review the deacon's ministry annually by submitting the Deacon Annual Assessment. The pastor should keep the deacon well informed on parish/institution matters.
G. The parish may assist the deacon financially with the cost of books and other materials or travel needed for his ministry.
H. Diaconal vestments (dalmatic, deacon stole, alb, cincture, amice) should be provided by the parish in the same way that priestly vestments are made available for priests. The pastor will determine the need for and style of such vestments in his parish.

COMMITMENT:

Relying on the Holy Spirit to enable us to fulfill our commitments, we enact this agreement.

Pastor/Administrator	Date
Deacon	Date
Deacon's Spouse	Date